

Elite class: Brazil's Alison dos Santos (45.98s; right) registered his second sub-46s timing in the 400m hurdles, a fortnight after breaking the world record. AP

presentation and the official event anthem was a great call as well.

Finally, only the winning athlete was honoured, with a unique trophy complemented by a personalised bracelet in recognition of the ultimate champion.

When it came to on-field performances, there were plenty of standout moments. USA's Melissa Jefferson-Wooden (21.47s) moved to third on the all-time women's 200m list.

Fellow American Kenny Bednarek (facing page, below), a two-time Olympic silver medallist, was similarly impressive, winning in 19.52sec to put him seventh on the all-time list.

Botswana's world champion Collen Kebinatshipi (43.39s; right) clocked the fifth-fastest time ever in the men's 400m. Brazil's Alison dos Santos (45.98s) registered his second sub-46s timing in the 400m hurdles, a fortnight after breaking the world record.

Algeria's Djamel Sedjati (far right, below) stunned Marco Arop and Emmanuel Wanyonyi to clinch the men's 800m crown. And Pathirage continued to enjoy one of the



all-time great seasons in the javelin throw by crossing the 90m mark in a third different competition.

The entire programme featured only 28 events. Some disciplines, such as the 10,000m, 3,000m steeplechase, discus throw, shot put, men's triple jump and women's hammer throw, were completely omitted.

"I really don't understand what your problem is, and even less so making this decision without any explanation. This isn't track and field and it's not good for our sport. Stop leaving us out," was how Portugal's Pedro Pichardo, the reigning men's triple jump

world champion, responded on social media after missing out on what could have been a career-changing night in monetary terms.

The omission wasn't as blatant as in Michael Johnson's effectively defunct Grand Slam Track, which ignored field events completely. But when the tournament organiser is the global governing body of the sport, such a decision is tough to digest for one of its most accomplished stars.

In its efforts to attract a younger and new audience, World Athletics has made a solid start with the Ultimate Championships. But when the next edition is held in 2028, it may have to rethink such exclusions.

